Sample Assignments

#1 Gender and Feminism in Asia: Creative Interpretation

Use a creative medium to adapt, interpret, or translate a work of your choice. Possible options include but are not limited to photography, video, painting, crochet, embroidery, creative writing, or other materials available at the Arts and Crafts Studio (on the lower level of Worner Campus Center).

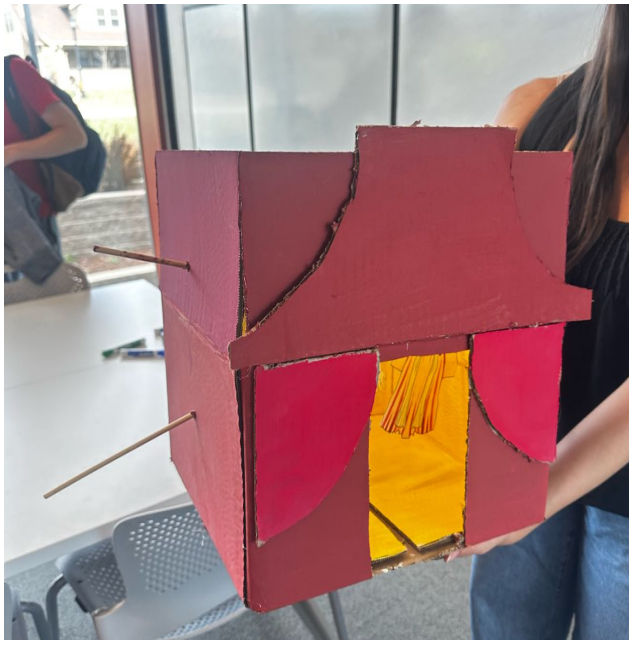
Potential ideas include (you're encouraged to explore your own):

- Creating a series of illustrations for *The Field of Life and Death*
- Learning and performing a Peking Opera piece such as *Farewell My Concubine* and filming your performance
- Reenacting and filming a scene from *Lust, Caution*
- Expanding a scene from The Vegetarian by writing from a different perspective
- Remixing K-pop dance videos to create a video essay

After completing your project, write a one-page reflective essay explaining your creative process and intent, and how your work relates to or enters into dialogue with your chosen literary or film work. Discuss your design and purpose, and how much your project fulfills your intention. Reflect on how your creation engages with or challenges norms of identity and experience and how it unsettles, reimagines, or expands perception.

Student Work: *The Vegetarian* Comic Strip, acted out with family members

Student Work: Interactive Theater Box inspired by *Farewell My Concubine*



#2 Animals, Plants, and Monsters: Zoo Field Trip and Creative Writing

We will visit the Cheyenne Mountain Zoo to meet the primates. We will spend time in front of the primate exhibit in silence doing free write. Use this time to write about the encounter between you and the animal. I invite you to be porous and let sensations penetrate your body and mind. Note what you see and feel, sense and smell; document movements and stillness, gestures, eyes, hair, shapes, emotions, affects that surface for both you and the animal. There are no rules for this free write—the only requirement is to be fully present with the encounter. We will then have a conversation to share impressions and brainstorm story ideas.

At home, expand your free write into a short story based on the encounter. Incorporate motifs from the stories we have read and watched.

You are free to experiment, but if you need ideas, here are some starting points:

• Imagine the Monkey King from China reincarnated as this primate in a Colorado zoo and escaping on a "Journey to the East."
• Rewrite Monkey King's Havoc in Heaven episode as "Havoc in the White House."
• Imagine a body exchange between you and the monkey—what happens when the monkey spends a day as a CC student?
• Invent your own scenario (highly encouraged!)